



Lab: Skills Self-Assessment

Estimated duration: 20 minutes

Objectives

- Assess your current project management skills across different competency categories
- Identify areas for improvement and develop a targeted action plan to reach the desired skill levels
- Establish measurable goals and timelines to track your skill development over time

Introduction

Understanding your current skills and competency levels is essential for determining eligibility for your desired job or role. The Project Management Institute (PMI) Talent Triangle provides a structured framework to evaluate your project management competencies, helping you identify strengths, gaps, and opportunities for growth. This lab will guide you through assessing your skills and creating a concrete action plan to develop them further.

Prerequisites

- You will be provided with a Template/Answer spreadsheet for this lab in Microsoft Excel format. Microsoft Excel or a Microsoft 365 online account is recommended.
- Alternative spreadsheet applications, such as Google Sheets, can also be used but may have limited functionality for drop-down menus or formulas.
- Prior to starting, review the following materials to familiarize yourself with key concepts:
 - [Video: The Predictive Project Management Framework: Key Activities](#)
 - [Reading: Project Management Skills for Non-Project Managers](#)

Exercise 1: Assess your current project management skills

The first step is to evaluate your current competency levels in the various skills required for effective project management.

1. Download the Project Management Skills Inventory spreadsheet by right clicking the below link and opening it in a new tab.
 - [Link to Project Management Skills Inventory Spreadsheet](#)
2. Review the spreadsheet carefully. Each skill is listed under its respective category, with fields for Current Skill Level, Intended Skill Level, and Action Plan.
3. For each skill, select the most appropriate rating from the Current Skill Level drop-down menu:
 - **High (H):** Demonstrates mastery and consistent application of skills. Able to lead others, adapt across contexts, and deliver strategic impact.
 - **Medium (M):** Applies skills with moderate confidence and effectiveness. Can contribute to projects and solve problems but may need guidance in complex or unfamiliar situations.
 - **Low (L):** Limited understanding or experience. Requires training, support, or practice to apply skills reliably in real-world settings.
4. Carefully consider each skill and avoid overestimating your abilities. Be honest and reflective; accurate self-assessment is critical for meaningful development.
5. Once all skills have been rated, review your selections. Look for patterns in strengths and gaps that may inform your focus areas for improvement.

Exercise 2: Develop an action plan to reach intended skill levels

In this exercise, you will create a structured plan to develop the skills you have identified as needing improvement.

1. Select 3 to 5 skills that you want to prioritize for improvement. Consider skills that are critical for your current role or future career aspirations.
2. Determine the intended skill level you aim to achieve for each selected skill. Choose a level that is challenging but realistic based on your career goals.
3. Develop a detailed action plan for each skill. Include:
 - Specific steps: Identify concrete activities, courses, mentorship opportunities, or hands-on experiences that will help you build the skill.
 - Progress metrics: Decide how you will measure improvement, such as successfully leading a project task, completing a certification, or receiving feedback from a supervisor.
 - Timeline: Set a realistic timeframe to achieve the intended skill level, keeping in mind other professional commitments.
4. Enter your action plans into the spreadsheet and save the file for future reference. Update it regularly as you make progress.

Remember that skill development is an ongoing process. Periodically reassess your competencies and refine your action plans to ensure continuous growth.

Tips for success

- Be honest and self-reflective during the assessment; overestimating your skills can hinder growth.
- Use your action plan as a living document. Revisit it monthly or quarterly to track progress and adjust goals.
- Seek feedback from peers, mentors, or supervisors to validate your self-assessment and identify blind spots.
- Focus on both technical project management skills and leadership/strategic skills as per the PMI Talent Triangle.

Summary

Being aware of your current skill levels, strengths, and gaps is critical for effective career planning and professional development. Conducting a thorough skills readiness check allows you to identify areas that need improvement, set measurable goals, and take deliberate actions toward becoming a more effective and confident project manager. Regular self-assessment and action planning are key to maintaining competency, adapting to evolving project demands, and achieving long-term career success.

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